



Test Case vs. Test Scenario

The "What" vs. The "How"

🏷️ Tags: QA, Testing, Documentation

🕒 Reading Time: 3 min

TL;DR

Test Scenario is a high-level description of what to test (One sentence).

Test Case is the detailed step-by-step instruction on how to test it (Many steps).

The Core Difference

These terms define the granularity of our work.

Granularity means the "level of detail." Think of it like a camera zoom: Scenarios are the "Zoomed Out" view, and Test Cases are the "Zoomed In" view.

Test Scenario (The Headline)

*Focus: **The Big Picture.***

- A single line stating a feature to be tested.
- Used for planning and discussing scope with stakeholders.
- Vague on details (it assumes you know how the system works).

Test Case (The Instruction)

*Focus: **The Specific Steps.***

- A detailed document including Pre-conditions, Test Data, Steps, and Expected Results.
 - Used for execution and documentation.
 - Very specific (even a junior tester should be able to follow it without asking questions).
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The Cooking Analogy

The Scenario:

"Bake a Chocolate Cake."

(This tells you what the goal is, but not how to achieve it).

The Test Case:

1. Preheat oven to 180°C.
2. Mix 200g flour and 50g cocoa powder.
3. Add 2 eggs.
4. Bake for 30 minutes.
5. Expected Result: A fluffy, cooked cake.

(This gives you the exact procedure to ensure consistency).

The Comparison Matrix

Component: Detail Level

- Scenario: Low (One line).
- Case: High (Detailed steps).

Component: Quantity

- Scenario: 1 Scenario (e.g., "Login").
- Case: Can be many Test Cases for 1 Scenario (e.g., "Login with valid pass", "Login with invalid pass", "Login with empty field").

Component: Audience

- Scenario: Business Analysts, Product Managers (Easy to read).
- Case: QA Testers, Developers (Technical and precise).

Component: Maintenance

- Scenario: Easy to maintain (rarely changes).
 - Case: Hard to maintain (breaks if UI changes slightly).
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Real World Example

Feature: User Login

Test Scenario:

"Verify the Login Functionality."

Test Cases (Derived from that Scenario):

1. **TC_001:** Verify login with valid username and valid password.

- *Step:* Enter "user@test.com" / "123456" → Click Login.
- *Result:* User is redirected to Dashboard.

2. TC_002: Verify login with invalid password.

- *Step:* Enter "user@test.com" / "wrongpass" → Click Login.
- *Result:* Error message "Invalid credentials" is displayed.

3. TC_003: Verify login with empty fields.

- *Step:* Leave fields blank → Click Login.
- *Result:* "Field is required" warning appears.